

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: North

Lead:  K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead:  3

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Lead:  Q

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4 

Declarer: West

Lead:  7

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead:  J

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 5 3

♥ 10 8 3

♦ 5

♣ Q 10 8 2

♠ A K 9

♥ A K 2

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 7 4



♠ Q 4

♥ Q J 9 6

♦ K Q 10 9 7

♣ K 6

♠ 8 7 2

♥ 7 5 4

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ 9 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by North

Lead: ♦K

NORTH has a perfect hand for an opening bid of 2♣. 23 points and balanced distribution is just fine.

SOUTH is glad to hear his partner has lots of points, because he was shortchanged. However, he must answer, so with 1 point he bids a negative 2♦.

NORTH describes her hand by saying 2NT. SOUTH does not have to bid the double negative over a 2NT bid, so he passes.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 3
♥ Q 8 2
♦ 10 9 8 6
♣ 5 4 2

♠ Q J 4

♥ 9 4 3

♦ 5 2

♣ A J 8 6 3



♠ A 8 2

♥ A K 7 5

♦ K Q J

♣ K Q 10

♠ 10 9 6 5

♥ J 10 6

♦ A 7 4 3

♣ 9 7

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♦3

EAST has a balanced hand with 22 points. He opens 2♣.

WEST, with 5 points, must respond ♦. Both these bids are artificial.

EAST now describes his hand by bidding 2NT.

WEST bids 3NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 27 points.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 4
♥ 9 3
♦ 6 5 3
♣ Q J 9 8 7 2

♠ Q J 10 7 2

♥ A 5

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 6 5 3



♠ A 8 6 5
♥ 10 8 7 6 4
♦ K J 10
♣ 10

♠ K 3

♥ K Q J 2

♦ A Q 9 8

♣ A K 4

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 22 points.

NORTH has 8 points AND a 5-card ♠ suit. This is strong enough for a positive response, so he bids 2♠.

SOUTH completes the description of her hand by saying 2NT.

NORTH does NOT rebid the ♠s; his first bid already promised a 5-card suit. He just bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 2
♥ A K Q 7 5
♦ A 7 2
♣ A 10

♠ 9 8 7 4

♥ J 4

♦ Q 10 5

♣ K J 5 3



♠ A 3

♥ 10 9 8 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 8 7 6 4

♠ J 10 6 5

♥ 6 3

♦ K J 4 3

♣ Q 9 2

WEST has 23 points and opens 2♣.

EAST, with 4 points, must respond 2♦.

WEST now shows a ♥ suit (at least 5) by bidding 2♥.

EAST likes ♥s, she has already told WEST she has fewer than 8 points, so she bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♠7			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 3
♥ Q 8 4 2
♦ K J 10 9
♣ 8 2

♠ A J 8 7

♥ A K

♦ A 8 6

♣ A K Q J



♠ K 5 4

♥ J 10 6

♦ 7 4 3

♣ 10 7 6 4

♠ Q 6 2

♥ 9 7 5 3

♦ Q 5 2

♣ 9 5 3

NORTH has lots of points - 26 to be exact. She opens 2♣. In the old days this hand would have been opened 3NT.

SOUTH has 4 points and responds 2♦.

NORTH now shows her full strength by jumping to 3NT (25-27 points, balanced).

SOUTH knows there is no slam, so he passes 3NT.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♥J			